Sense of school community scale – secondary

1. **This scale consists of 18 items organised into two subscales:**

(a) School supportiveness (items 1-9)

(b) Pupil autonomy and influence (items 10 – 18)

2. **Scale items that were 'reversed-scored':** 2, 3, 6, 7, 8, 11, 15

Scoring

3. **Table 1: Five point Likert scale for responding to scale items**

Disagree a lot	Disagree a little	Neither agree or disagree	Agree a little	Agree a lot
1	2	3	4	5

4. **Obtaining subscale and full scale scores scores**

- Item scores for each subscale are averaged to get a subscale score.
- Full scale score is obtained by averaging the subscale scores.

5. **Scoring grid**

Very high	4.00 and above
High	3.42-3.99
Average	3.03-3.41
	2.64-3.02
	2.25-2.63
Low	1.67-2.24
Very Low	1.66 and above

6. Interpretation

Sense of school community tends to decrease with age and school averages have been found to be more variable across secondary schools. Battistich et al. (2004) reported an overall average of 2.83 in a sample of secondary schools, where scores above 3.41 might be considered above average and scores below 2.25 below average.

Sense of school community scales – Primary

1. Questions 4, 5, 8, 9, 10, 21, 22, 25, 27,31 all reverse coded

2. School community subscales:
   - Classroom supportiveness (mean of 14 subscale items, 1-14)

- School supportiveness (mean of 14 subscale items, 15-28)
- Classroom Autonomy (mean of 10 subscales, 29-38)

Scoring Grid

Very high (1)	3.30- above
High (2)	3.13-3.29
Average (3)	3.06-3.12
	2.99-3.05
	2.92-2.98
	2.85-2.91
	2.78-2.84
Low (4)	2.61-2.77
Very Low(5)	2.60 and below

3. Interpretation:

Results from 24 primary schools from a US study by Battistich et al. (1995) is used as a basis for cautious comparison. The highest school average score in the study was 3.29, while the lowest was 2.56. The average score across all 24 schools of 2.95, almost exactly at the scale midpoint, and standard deviation of 0.17 indicates that for this comparison sample scores above 3.12 can be considered above average and those below 2.78. below average.

School belonging questionnaire:

1. For items: 1, 2, 4, 6, 7, 11, and 12 – 1=No not true; 2=? Not sure and 3=Yes true
2. Reverse the scores on items: 3, 5, 8, 9 and 10. - 3= No not true; 2=? Not sure and 1=Yes true
3. Add scores for each item and divide by 12 to get peoples average score. This is the belonging Scale score.
4. The percentage of pupils in a class or school with a low belonging score can be calculated by dividing the number of pupils who score below'2' by the number of pupil who completed the measure and multiplying by 100.

Interpretation

A mid-point of 2 can be used to identify pupils who have a low sense of belonging and may be at risk of alienation. (However, this is normed on a UK study by (Frederickson et al. 2007) on 397 children from years 3 to 6 in 14 schools. A mean score below 2 was obtained by 16 percent of the sample).

In retrospect, The Psychological Sense of School Membership Scale (PSSM) should have been used for the secondary school sample as this was developed for pupils aged 10-14 years. The belonging scale that was used was a version of the PSSM scale, reduced from 18 to 12 items, anglicised and simplified for use with children as young as 8 years.

I am unsure as to how this will affect the interpretation of the secondary school scores as the scale midpoint of 3.0 is regarded as the 'tipping point' below which a pupil is considered to be more negative than positive in their response on the PSSM scale.

Sense of school connectedness scale

- Scores on each item are summed for each scale. This gives a total score of between 6 and 30.

There is presently no normative or national data in the UK for this scale. However, Ozer et al. (2008) provide guidance about school connectedness scores that could be categorised as 'Low', 'Midpoint' and High.

Scoring Grid

6-18 = low

19-23 = average

24-30 = above average